UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Sales and Services Associate Training

Administrator Guide

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Employee Resource Management

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Sales and Services Associate Training

Administrator Guide

United States Postal Service
Employee Resource Management
Retail Operations
475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
Washington, D.C.

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A Commitment to Diversity

The Postal Service is committed to fostering and achieving a work and learning environment that respects and values a diverse workforce. Valuing and managing diversity in the Postal Service means that we will build an inclusive environment that respects the uniqueness of every individual and encourages the contributions, experiences and perspectives of all people.

It is essential that our work and learning environments be free from discrimination and harassment on any basis.

In our classrooms, on the workroom floor, in casual conversation and in formal meetings, employees and faculty are asked to encourage an open learning environment that is supportive of everyone.

Course materials and lectures, classroom debates and casual conversation should always reflect the commitment to safety and freedom from discrimination, sexual harassment and harassment on any prohibited basis. Instructors and class participants are expected to support this commitment.

If you find course material that is presented in the classroom or in self-instructional format that does not follow these guidelines, please let an instructor know immediately.

If classroom discussions do not support these principles, please point that out to the instructor as well.

Diversity is a source of strength for our organization. Diversity promotes innovation, creativity, productivity and growth, and enables a broadening of existing concepts.

The Postal Service's policy is to value the diversity of our employees, customers and suppliers, and to do what is right for our employees and the communities we serve, thereby ensuring a competitive advantage in the global marketplace.

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Preface

The Sales and Services Associate (SSA) Training program is the result of a collaborative effort between the APWU, USPS management, Retail Operations, Channel Access, and Training and Development to improve training for sales and services associates.

The 2012 revision reflects the continued collaboration of the American Postal Workers Union with postal management in providing current and effective training for new sales and services associates.

This course is designed to provide sales and services associates with the basic skills and knowledge to perform the duties of their positions. The course is also designed to provide sales and services associates and window clerks with refresher training.

Purpose of Guide

These instructions are designed to provide USPS managers, training staff, functional instructors, and other field personnel with the policies and procedures for administration of course 10021146, *Sales and Services Associate (SSA) Training*.

The success of this course requires the cooperative efforts of Headquarters and Area Managers and personnel, District Managers, the American Postal Workers Union (APWU), Retail Managers, Learning Development and Diversity (LD&D) Managers, Operations Managers/Supervisors, retail coaches, sales and services associates, and window clerks. These instructions are designed to enhance the effectiveness of these cooperative efforts.

Purpose of Course

This course is designed to provide sales and services associates and window clerks with the knowledge and skills to effectively and efficiently perform their retail responsibilities. The course also provides the information needed to pass the end-of-training qualifying examination, in accordance with the terms of the National Agreement.

The course administrators and instructors should study the National Agreement, Article 37.3.F.7, Article 37.1.L, and Memorandums of Understanding and Letters of Intent, to ensure that the training is conducted in accordance with the policies contained therein.

This training is required for the following positions:

- Sales and Services Associate (2320-0001)
- Sales, Services, and Distribution Associate (2320-0003)
- PSE Sales and Services/Distribution Associate (2395-0017)
- PSE Post Office Clerk (2395-0016)

Note: Successful completion of this training and passing of the qualifying examination is also required for part-time flexible (PTF) employees assigned to these duties. Individual modules of this training program may be used to provide window clerks, or other employees as appropriate, with brush-up training.

This program will provide a basic working knowledge of interpersonal skills, customer relations, selling techniques, postal products and services, as well as financial procedures and responsibilities to sales and services associates. Given the various duties performed by postal personnel at retail counters, other training may be required upon completion of this course.

In addition to the Sales and Services Associate Training program, retail employees who will accept bulk mailings should take additional training as appropriate (either online or as dictated by local policy).

Course Structure

The Sales and Services Associate (SSA) Training program, which is designed for delivery through the USPS training network, is a combination of eLearning and classroom instructor-led training, followed by a qualifying examination, and on-the-job training (OJT).

The sixteen eLearning training modules:

- are accessed via the USPS, Learning Management System (LMS).
- must be completed at 100% as noted in the LMS.
- will be reviewed during the classroom instructor-led portion of the training process.

Participants will have 7 days to complete all SSA eLearning training requirements in order to be scheduled for the classroom instructor-led training portion of the program.

There must be no more than 7 days between the completion of the eLearning modules and the start of classroom training.

or

Classroom training must begin within 7 days after the completion of the eLearning modules.

The classroom training provides training on those elements common to all sales and services associates, such as interpersonal skills, customer relations, selling techniques, postal products and services, as well as financial procedures and responsibilities.

Modules are presented in a classroom environment. Instructional methodologies include demonstration, role-play, presentation, and reading.

Once the classroom training has been completed, the future associates are allowed 1 hour of review time before administering the required SSA qualifying examination (421). Future associates are responsible for all content received in the classroom, including the contents of Modules 17-41 in the SSA Training participant guide.

The qualifying examination must be scheduled on the first workday following completion of the classroom training.

When the associate has successfully passed the qualifying exam, a retail coach or lead sales and services associate (LSSA) will be assigned to the future associate to provide On-the-Job Training (OJT).It is also recommended that the OJT portion of the training be conducted starting on Monday and ending on Friday to optimize the opportunity for customer interaction. It is recommended that the OJT portion of the training be administered immediately following the successful completion of the qualifying exam.

The OJT must be completed within 14 calendar days upon the completion of the qualifying exam.

The 14-day time period does not include any scheduled leave of the future associate during the same time period.

The OJT moves the future associate to their bid, assigned unit, or in some cases, to designated retail training sites where they work one-on-one with their retail coach (or LSSA). During this time, the retail coach or lead sales and services associate will focus upon reinforcing information provided during the classroom portion of the training, retail equipment, revenue generation, proper transaction workflows, and proper financial procedures.

Figure I

Sales and Services Associate Training Process Flowchart

Pre-classroom

eLearning (9 hours)

Module 1: Understanding the USPS #10019885
Module 2: Growing the Business #10019886
Module 3: Directives #10021001
Module 4: Hazardous Materials (Hazmat) #10021006
Module 5: Anonymous Mail #10020997
Module 6: Domestic Mail #10021003
Module 7: International Mail #10020994
Module 8: Priority Mail Express #10021004
Module 9: Priority Mail #10020995
Module 10: Confirmation Services #10021000
Module 11: Insured Mail #10021007
Module 12: Certified Mail #10020998
Module 13: Registered Mail #10020996
Module 14: Collect on Delivery (COD) #10020999
Module 15: Extra Services #10021005
Module 16: Domestic and International Claims #10021002

Classroom Training (24 hours)

Module 17: Sales and Services Associate
Module 18: Discovery Map – Focusing on Customers
Module 19: Communication Skills
Module 20: Selling Techniques
Module 21: Mailability, Processing Categories and Machinability
Module 22: Product Knowledge and Best Value
Module 23: Dimensional Weight Pricing
Module 24: Products eLearning Review
Module 25: P.O. Box Service
Module 26: Public Service Agencies/ Change of Address (COA)
Module 27: Services eLearning Review
Module 28: The Customer Experience
Module 29: Completing the Perfect Transaction
Module 30: Handling Challenging Customer Experiences
Module 31: Using Retail Communication Channels/Expanded Access
Module 32: Retail Equipment
Module 33: Accountability
Module 34: Establishing a Stamp Credit
Module 35: Daily Financial Report
Module 36: Acceptable Payment methods
Module 37: Credit Card Compliance
Module 38: Money Orders
Module 39: Security and Sanctity of the Mail
Module 40: Policy and Security eLearning Review
Module 41: Union Model

Structured Scenarios and Interaction

Videos

Review Time for Qualifying Examination
(1 hour)

Computer-based Qualifying Examination
(2 hours)

OJT

(40 hours)

- At bid office or designated retail training site
- Most training completed with customer at retail counter
- One-on-one with retail coach
- Includes 8 hours of POS eLearning for POS offices or hands on training for manual offices

(See pages 10 – 11)

Course Description

eLearning Modules

The Sales and Services Associate (SSA) Training eLearning modules provide training on those elements common to all sales and services associates, such as Postal products and services, policy, and security. Modules are presented in a computer/eLearning environment. Successful completion of the sixteen eLearning modules by future associates is recorded and tracked in the LMS. The eLearning portion of the training is designed to take 9 training hours.

Classroom Training

The Sales and Services Associate Training classroom modules provide training on those elements common to all sales and services associates, such as interpersonal skills, customer relations, selling techniques, postal products and services, as well as financial procedures and responsibilities. Modules are presented in a classroom environment. Instructional methodologies include demonstration, role-play, video, and presentation.

Class Duration

The classroom portion of the Sales and Services Associate Training program is designed to take 24 training hours.

Class Size

The recommended class size includes a minimum of four and a maximum of twelve students. At a minimum, having four future associates allows for classroom interaction, group exercises, participation in role-plays, and future associates/classroom instructor discussions. The Manager, LD&D will determine the number of future associates for each class based on the ratio of classroom facilitators to future associates.

Management will not provide sales and services associate on-the-job training to any bargaining unit employee who has not successfully completed the eLearning and classroom portion of the training, and passed the qualifying exam.

Bargaining employees who have not passed the qualifying exam are prohibited from working the window. Not to do so compromises Postal Service retail professionalism, customer relations, service commitments, and accountable funds.

Qualifying Examination

The qualifying examination is administered at the end of the classroom training program, using a USPS ACE computer. Only a certified examiner may administer the qualifying examination, *and the examiner may NOT be the instructor for the course*.

> **Note: The qualifying examination should be administered on the first workday following the completion of the classroom portion of the training.**

Retesting Policy

All trainees who fail the qualifying examination at the end of training must wait 180 days before being able to take the test again. As the qualifying exams can only be given at the end of the classroom training program, all individuals must be retrained in the classroom as well.

Authorization to retest before the 180 days is normally sought when there is a circumstance where the incorrect series or obsolete material was used or there were difficulties during the administration of the exam – disturbances, timing errors, etc. – which did not provide the applicant a fair opportunity to demonstrate his/her qualifications for the exam. Exam administrators are familiar with the documentation requirements in such instances.

Requests for retest within 180 days, in cases where there were no defects in the original examination process, must be submitted to Training and Development, Testing and Assessment, ED Exam Services. Requests must be accompanied by a letter from the Manager, Human Resources providing a complete explanation for the proposed exception to the 180-day retest period. Requests may be submitted for higher level review.

If an Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) complaint or grievance is filed by an employee alleging a problem during the test, Training and Development, Testing and Assessment, ED Exam Services can provide assistance in determining whether a proposed settlement is reasonable. If the resolution is that they be provided another opportunity to take the exam, the Manager, Human Resources submits a letter to Training and Development, Testing and Assessment, ED Exam Services with a brief explanation for the files.

An office cannot approve a retest for an examinee without Training and Development, Testing and Assessment, ED Exam Services' concurrence. Failure to obtain Training and Development, Testing and Assessment, ED Exam Services' approval will result in the invalidation of retest scores.

Retest decisions are not made by local managers.

Final Selection

The future associate must correctly answer 80% of the questions on the qualifying exam, and complete 40 hours of On-the-Job Training with a retail coach (or LSSA) in order to be deemed qualified and eligible to assume the bid or assignment.

On-the-Job Training

A thorough, well-documented, On-the-Job Training (OJT) process is critical to the success of the Sales and Services Associate (SSA) Training program. As the OJT is based on the Sales and Services Unit Profile of the future associate's gaining office, future associates may have slightly different OJT experiences.

The OJT must be conducted on a one-on-one basis between the retail coach or lead sales and services associate and the future associate. This one-on-one training should occur during the normal transaction of business at the retail service counter. One-on-one training is defined as the retail coach (or LSSA) and the future associate working at one retail service counter or in the back office. The retail coach (or LSSA) may role-play examples of specific transactions with the future associate.

Retail coaches and lead sales and services associate must make every effort to conduct the on-the-job training by mixing role-playing and customer interactions.

Hours spent in training will be properly documented on PS Form 2432, *Individual Training Progress Sheet*, on a daily basis. Once the training has been completed the information must be documented by recording completion of the training event into the Postal Services' Learning Management System (LMS).

In instances where it is not possible for the future associate to receive OJT at their bid or assigned office, a training site should be established. To ensure the highest quality OJT, a training site should be defined as one where the postmaster level is equal to or greater than an EAS-18 ranking.

Each OJT training site should have a minimum of two fully-equipped retail service counters that can adequately accommodate the OJT experience without negatively impacting service to retail customers, regardless of the level of office.

Any office, station, or branch selected to conduct the on-the job portion of the training should have sufficient customer volume to provide all the transactions that the trainee will be required to master in order to be proficient in their assigned retail office duties.

Retail coaches (or LSSAs) may voluntarily go on-site to conduct the OJT. Appropriate reimbursement for lodging, per diem, and travel is authorized in accordance with Handbook F-15, *Travel and Relocation*, and ELM 716. Local operations managers may elect to exercise this option based upon commuting distance and the suitability of the retail operation where the OJT will occur.

During the OJT, future associates, with the retail coach/lead sales and services associate present must be issued a retail cash or stamp credit consignment. PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Receipt*, must be prepared in triplicate by the person consigning the credit.

The future associate who accepts responsibility for the credit must date and sign the form in accordance with Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures* and the procedures outlined in Article 28 of the National Agreement. During the OJT, the future associate must be given a retail credit count and the credit will be closed out according to the procedures in Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*.

The retail coach/lead sales and services associate must be present during the consignment and final count of the future associate's accountability.

OJT Duration

The SSA receives 40 hours of on-the-job training. The OJT will be conducted one-on-one (one retail coach or lead sales and services associate and one future associate). It is important that the retail coach (or LSSA) review and understand each of the transactions to ensure the workflow is taught properly. Ensure that current information and manuals are being used and provided.

When OJT begins, the retail coach (or LSSA) reviews the Trainee Daily OJT Checklist and the equipment needed to complete retail transactions with the future associate.

OJT includes 8 hours of POS training for POS offices, or hands on training for manual offices.

Training Documentation

Classroom Training

The following document is used to facilitate the completion of the sales and services associate classroom training:

- PS Form 2432, *Individual Training Progress Sheet*
- Hours spent in training will be properly documented on PS Form 2432, *Individual Training Progress Sheet*, daily. Once training forms have been completed information must be documented by recording completion of the training event into the Postal Service's Learning Management System (LMS).

On-the-Job Training

The following document is used to facilitate and complete the OJT:

Training Hours and Schedules

The training and qualifying examination must be given on-the-clock. Time for the future associate and retail coach (or LSSA) will be recorded as follows:

- Record and charge all time in class or study as training hours to the ***gaining retail unit***. This applies when the future associate is observing the retail coach (or LSSA) or, when the retail coach (or LSSA) is observing the future associate.

Charge the time used for the written examination to ***training.***

If, during the future associate's training, it becomes necessary to change the scheduled hours of work, the change may only be accomplished in accordance with the procedures specified in the Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM).

- Use the Learning Management System (LMS) to record Sales and Services Associate training hours.
  - Course #10021146 should be used to record students' completion of the classroom portion of the training program
  - Course #10021148 should be used to record that students have completed the qualifying examination.
  - Course #10021228 should be used to record that students have completed the on-the-job training.

Selection of Classroom Instructors

The careful selection of craft employees as classroom instructors is critical to the success of the Sales and Services Associate Training program.

The Manager, LD&D along with other appropriate managers, will select a sufficient number of classroom instructors.

As classroom instructors are needed, not to exceed (NTE), senior qualified ad-hoc duty assignments should be posted. All postings should be filled in accordance with the APWU National Agreement.

The primary classroom instructors for Sales and Services Associate Training should be selected on a voluntary basis from the following retail experienced positions:

- Lead Sales and Services Associate, (P7-07)
- Sales, Services and Distribution Associate, (P7-06)
- Sales and Services Associate, (P7-06)
- Window Clerk, (P7-06);
- Distribution and Window Clerk, (P7-06)
- Distribution, Window, and Mark-Up Clerk, (P7-06)
- Delivery/Sales Services and Distribution Associate, (P7-06)

Classroom instructors must have one year of continuous retail experience in one or more of the retail positions listed and hold one of the retail duty assignments at the time of consideration. To maintain retail proficiency, they must spend a minimum of 40 hours in their regular retail duty assignment once every four months. In addition, classroom instructors must return to their full-time retail assignment during the month of December to assist operations during the holiday mailing season.

Classroom instructors must voluntarily accept the assignment. Therefore, any changes in schedules to perform instructor duties will be considered voluntary and not subject to out-of-schedule premium. Each volunteer must complete PS Form 1717, *Bid for Preferred Assignment* or electronic equivalent.

Employees voluntarily bidding for a classroom instructor position are notified of the intention to use information contained in official records, available as of the closing date, to determine qualification. If available evidence of a potential classroom instructor's qualification information is not complete, they should take action to provide the Manager, LD&D and/or the Manager, Retail with the appropriate information to update their records prior to the bid closing date.

This decision as to the number of classroom instructors is left to the discretion of the district training office. The decision should take into account availability of instructors, commuting distance to the classroom, interaction between the classroom instructor and the district training office, as well as overall business and cost considerations.

If local offices fail to produce a suitable number and caliber of classroom instructor volunteers, the area of coverage may be expanded to fill the necessary classroom instructor needs.

It is essential that selected instructors be provided adequate on-the-clock preparation time to successfully fulfill their responsibilities. Some of these duties include setting up and maintaining retail training academies, familiarizing themselves with instructional materials (including videos), ordering and stocking necessary manuals, handbooks, forms, and other directives, incorporating procedural and policy changes into the training materials, etc.

Special Considerations

In addition to possessing appropriate experience, classroom instructors should be articulate, enthusiastic, and personable. They should exhibit behaviors expected from role models. Since classroom instructors may represent the Postal Service to the public, they must exemplify adherence to the current official U.S. Postal Service uniform policy. Instructors must be in full uniform when conducting Sales and Services Associate training. Classroom instructors must be neat and presentable in their personal appearance. Successfully selected ad-hoc Classroom Instructors are paid at the (PS-7) rate.

Training Requirements

Once selected, classroom instructors must complete the Sales and Services Associate Training - eLearning modules, and be trained in instructional methods and coaching skills before they are utilized as instructors. Selected classroom instructors must successfully complete the following courses:

- Facilitative Instructor Workshop, Course (21201-61or 10020351)
- FS: SSA: Retail Coaching Guidelines (10021227)
- Job Instructor Training (21505-00)

Because of their classroom experience and OJT training, classroom instructors will also be able to serve as retail coaches when vacancies or absences occur.

Upon the recommendation and approval of the Manager, LD&D, the Manager, LD&D maintains a list of approved retail coaches for SSA OJT.

Within six months of selection, classroom instructors must attend and/or observe one classroom session of the Sales and Services Associate Training program and instruct one classroom session which is observed by a certified SSA classroom instructor. This will help update their technical skills, as well as address any issues concerning elements of the course.

Every two years, classroom instructors will be required to successfully complete an FIW/OJT refresher training class.

Selection of Retail Coaches

The careful selection of craft employees as retail coaches is critical to the success of the Sales and Services Associate Training program.

The Manager, LD&D, along with other appropriate managers, will select a cadre of retail coaches. The decision as to the number of retail coaches is left at the discretion of the district training office. The decision should take into account availability of coaches, commuting distance if training at units other than their own, interaction between the retail coach and the district training office, as well as overall business and cost considerations.

The retail coaches must be selected on a voluntary basis from the following retail experienced positions:

- Lead Sales and Services Associate, (P7-07)
- Sales, Services and Distribution Associate, (P7-06)
- Sales and Services Associate, (P7-06)
- Window Clerk, (P7-06);
- Distribution and Window Clerk, (P7-06)
- Distribution, Window, and Mark-Up Clerk, (P7-06)
- Delivery/Sales Services and Distribution Associate, (P7-06)

Retail coaches must have one year of continuous retail experience in one or more of the retail positions listed and hold one of the retail duty assignments at the time of consideration.

Retail coaches must voluntarily accept the assignment. Therefore, any changes in schedules to perform instructor duties will be considered voluntary and not subject to out-of-schedule premium. Retail coaches may voluntarily go on-site to conduct OJT.

Lead sales and services associates may serve as a retail coach for training new SSAs, SSDAs, and PSEs for the OJT without having to attend the SSA retail coach training.

Special Considerations

In addition to possessing appropriate experience, retail coaches should be articulate, enthusiastic, and personable. They should exhibit behaviors expected from role models. Since retail coaches may represent the Postal Service to the public, they must exemplify adherence to the current official U.S. Postal Service uniform policy. They must be in full uniform when conducting Sales and Services Associate Training. Retail coaches must be neat and presentable in their personal appearance. Successfully selected ad-hoc Retail Coaches are paid at the (PS-7) rate.

Training Requirements

Once selected retail coaches must be trained in instructional methods and coaching skills before they are utilized as coaches. Selected retail coaches must complete the following courses:

- RET: SSA: Retail Coaching Guidelines (10021227)
- Job Instructor Training (21505-00)

The Manger, LD&D maintains a list of approved retail coaches for SSA OJT.

Retail coaches tasked to facilitate the Sales and Services Associate OJT on the POS ONE System must have successfully completed the POS ONE Front Office course. This course can be obtained from the POS ONE Training website.

Retail coaches will be provided with a Sales and Services Associate Training Facilitator Guide for reference and use during OJT.

Every two years, retail coaches will be required to successfully complete an OJT refresher-training course.

Program Responsibilities

Manager, Learning Development and Diversity (MLDD)

Before the Training

- Select, train, and certify classroom instructors and retail coaches (or LSSA) in cooperation with functional managers. An adequate number of certified classroom instructors and retail coaches (or LSSAs) should be maintained. The success of the Sales and Services Associate Training program will depend upon the professional integrity and high caliber of the classroom instructors and retail coaches (or LSSAs) who are selected to conduct the sessions, as outlined in this administrator's guide.
- Ensure that classroom instructors are provided up to 8 hours of preparation time before administering sales and services associate classroom training. This will vary, for the first sales and services associate class as much as 8 hours will be needed whereas, by the third class only 4 to 6 hours will be needed.
- Ensure that retail coaches (or LSSAs) are provided 2 hours of preparation time before administering On-the-Job Training, and 2 hours post training time.
- Obtain proper identification badge for the trainee.
- Notify unit manager where OJT will take place and ensure that preliminary set-ups for retail equipment are in place (i.e. POS – assign roles, request log on Ids, etc.).

During the Training

- Invite the installation head, or their designee, to "open" the classroom session to demonstrate local management's commitment to Sales and Services Associate training. Such participation adds credibility to the program.
- Prepare class rosters. Class rosters should contain the start date, program number and title, instructor's name, program length, and location. Rosters should be completed and finalized during the first day of the class.
- ***Future associate absences during the Sales and Services Associate Training program, while undesirable, may occasionally be unavoidable:***

  - **Classroom:** If a future associate misses more than one day of classroom training, the future associate should be removed from the training and rescheduled. Absences from the classroom of one day or less will require make-up time. Make-up classroom time may be with a classroom instructor or may be administered on a self-study basis.
  - **OJT**: If a future associate misses more than one day of OJT, the future associate should be removed from the training and rescheduled. Absences from the OJT of less than one day will require make-up time. Make-up OJT must be conducted one-on-one between the future associate and the retail coach/lead sales and services associate.
- If the future associate withdraws from the Sales and Services Associate Training program, handle this according to Article 37.3.F.7 of the National Agreement.
- Maintain quality control of the classroom instructors and retail coaches/lead sales and services associates. The successful delivery of Sales and Services Associate training depends upon the integrity of the training materials, the professionalism of the instructors, and the support of functional managers. The training staff, with the support of functional field and district managers will monitor quality control and compliance of the program.
- Prepare PS Form 2548, Individual Training Record as soon as names are received.
- Ensure that instructors review training materials and use Postal Bulletins and/or manuals to temporarily update training materials, as needed. Revised materials will be periodically distributed to the district training offices from Training and Development.
- Oversee the administration of the Sales and Services Associate training. This responsibility includes coordinating with the appropriate managers the resources needed to administer and conduct the training. The course must be administered according to the guidelines in the National Agreement and this Administrator's Guide. When part-time flexible (PTF) or Postal Support Employees (PSE) are assigned retail duties, they will be subject to the same qualification procedures as employees who bid for retail duty assignments.

- Within six months of selection, classroom instructors must attend and/or observe one classroom session of the Sales and Services Associate Training program and instruct one classroom session which is observed by a certified SSA classroom instructor. This will help update their technical skills, as well as address any issues concerning elements of the course
- Retail coaches will be provided with a Sales and Services Associate Training Facilitator Guide for reference and use during OJT.

Manager, Retail (Or Designee)

Before the Training

- Coordinate with the Manager, LD&D (or designee), the selection of On-the-Job training sites.
- Coordinate with the Manager, LD&D, careful selection of classroom instructors and retail coaches (or LSSA). The instructors and retail coaches (or LSSA) should be role models for new sales and services associates.
- Ensure that retail coaches (or LSSAs) are provided 2 hours of preparation time before administering structured on-the job training, and 2 hours post training time.

During the Training

- Support the training staff by providing supplemental materials and manuals, retail coaches (or LSSAs), and guest subject matter experts, to ensure that local policies, procedures, and issues are addressed in the Sales and Services Associate Training program.
- Assist the training staff to ensure that the training is administered and conducted according to this Administrator's Guide, as well as postal policies and procedures.

After the Training

- Support the training staff by providing supplemental materials, guest subject matter experts.
- Reinforce skills and knowledge by Postmasters or Managers, Customer Services with information to help sales and services associates and window clerks apply newly acquired skills on-the-job.
- Support postmaster and managers by providing job aids that help keep sales and services associates current on postal products and services.
- Update retail offices on any changes in policies and procedures that involve postal products and services and/or retail operations.

The above strategies are essential to help sales and services associates to be successful in their positions after completion of the Sales and Services Associate Training program.

Future Associate's Manager/Postmaster

Before the Training

- Coordinate with the district training office or the servicing Postal Employee Development Center (PEDC) to schedule and notify the future associate of the scheduled Sales and Services Associate training classes.
- In order to be issued a password to work on the POS ONE system future associates must complete a PS Form 1357, *Request for Computer Access.* It is your responsibility to ensure this form is completed properly and submitted prior to the future associate reporting for training.
- Explain travel policy and procedures to the future associate. Assist the future associate in securing driving directions, overnight lodging, or air travel arrangements.
- Thoroughly review the course objectives with the future associate before the beginning of the classroom training.
- Ensure that the retail coach (or LSSA) is given adequate time to prepare before administering On-the Job Training; 2 hours preparation prior, and 2 hours post training time.
- Ensure that the retail coach (or LSSA) is present during consignment of the future associate's accountability.

During the Training

- Ensure that equipment and supplies are ordered and on-hand for the newly trained sales and services associate.

After the Training

- Reinforce skills and knowledge by helping sales and services associates and window clerks apply newly acquired skills On-the-Job.
- Support sales and services associates and window clerks by providing additional training experiences, having reference materials, such as manuals, handbooks, and bulletins available for them to use.
- Have job aids available at work sites to help keep retail coaches (or LSSAs) current on postal products and services.
- Update retail coaches (or LSSAs) and sales and services associates on any changes in policies and procedures that involve postal products and services and/or retail operations.
- **Ensure that the retail coach/lead sales and services associate is present during the final count of future associate's accountability.**

Classroom Instructors

Before the Training

- Classroom instructors will need 8 hours of preparation time before administering the Sales and Services Associate classroom training. This will vary, for the first Sales and Services Associate class as much as 8 hours will be needed whereas, by the third class only 4 to 6 hours will be needed.
- Thoroughly review the training materials. In order to conduct a successful training session, it is essential that the instructor be familiar with the training materials and instructional methods used.
- Ensure all materials are current and available. When handouts and reference materials are needed, it is the instructor's responsibility to have them ready to use and distribute.
- Refer to instructions in each module to determine classroom equipment and support materials needed and ensure that they are in place before the start of the class.
- Arrange the classroom so that it comfortably accommodates the number of scheduled future associates.

- Ensure that the training room is well lit and sufficiently ventilated.

During the Training

- Provide the necessary learning experiences that actively engage the future associate through adult learning techniques, such as demonstration, role-playing, presentations, etc.
- Complete class roster for Sales and Services Associate Training. The roster must be completed during the first day of class. ***If a future associate leaves the class after the roster is completed, it is the classroom instructor's responsibility to notify the training department.***
- Maintain a positive attitude. This training represents a corporate commitment to the training and development of retail employees. Therefore, instructors who demonstrate the principles of effective interpersonal behavior are a major element in ensuring the success of this national program.
- Classroom instructors must exhibit exemplary behavior and presentation skills, as well as a professional appearance. Adherence to the official Postal Service uniform policy is essential. Instructors qualifying for a uniform allowance must be in full uniform at all times while training.

After the Training

Complete and sign all necessary paperwork and documentation which includes:

- Assure all SSAs and participants receive credit for training
- PS Form 2432, Individual Training Progress Sheet (ATF training entry in the LMS)
- Follow all local guidelines and procedures to promptly submit all required paperwork.
- Suggestions and recommendations concerning the training materials may be sent in writing to:

  Training and Development
  Attention: P&SD
  475 L'Enfant Plaza SW, Room 9671
  Washington, DC 20260-4201

Retail Coaches/Lead Sales and Services Associate

Before the Training

- Retail coaches (or LSSA) will need 2 hours of preparation time before administering On-the-Job Training.
- Ensure that all materials are current and available. When handouts and reference materials are needed, the retail coach (or LSSA) is responsible for having them ready to use and/or distribute.
- Solicit support from the other retail employees in the office or station. Retail employees and the retail coach (or LSSA) may want to coordinate their customer service efforts to provide the trainee with the widest variety of customer transactions possible.
- ***The retail coach (or LSSA) must be present during initial consignment of the future associate's accountability.***

During the Training

- Provide the necessary learning experiences that actively engage the future associate through adult learning techniques, such as demonstration, role-playing, presentations, etc.
- Accurately maintain and document all necessary training records as training evolutions are completed.
- Maintain communication with the station manager and district training office regarding the future associate's progress.
- Maintain an upbeat and positive attitude while working with the future associate.
- Retail coaches (or LSSA) must exhibit exemplary behavior and presentation skills, as well as a professional appearance. Adherence to the official Postal Service uniform policy is essential. Retail coaches (or LSSAs) must be in full uniform at all times while training.

After the Training

- The retail coach (or LSSA) must be present during final count of future associate's accountability.
- Retail coaches (or LSSA) will need 2 hours of post training time.
- Complete and sign all necessary paperwork and documentation which includes:
  - PS Form 2548, *Individual Training Record*
- Follow all local guidelines and procedures to ensure all associates have received credit for training.

Additional Considerations

Subject Matter Experts and Guest Instructors

Subject matter experts or guest instructors may be used, if possible, to make presentations to support the following modules:

- Module 39: Security and Sanctity of the Mail (optional)
- Module 41: APWU Module (Union Representative must present this module.)

Training staffs may obtain support from other subject matter experts, if possible, to assist with the course. ***All guest speakers must follow scripting of the course to ensure consistency.***

Student Guidelines

For specific information regarding deferment periods, brush-up and refresher training, refer to Articles 37.3.F.7 and 37.1.L of the National Agreement, Handbook EL-912, and the referenced Memorandums of Understanding and Letters of Intent.

Training Materials

- SSA Administrator Guide
- SSA On-the-Job Training Workbook
- Standard Training for Retail Coaches - SSA

Sample Posting

JOB ANNOUNCEMENT

AD-HOC SALES and SERVICES ASSOCIATE TRAINING CLASSROOM INSTRUCTOR POSITIONS

The following job announcement for Sales and Services Associate Training Classroom Instructor positions is being posted for volunteers. This represents a unique job opportunity for retail employees. The selection of Classroom Instructors will be from a pool of volunteers. Therefore, any changes in schedules to perform instructor duties will be considered voluntary and not subject to out-of-schedule premium.

The Classroom Instructors will be selected from offices and installations within a reasonable commuting distance to the Retail Training Academy site. If the area of consideration fails to produce a sufficient number of qualified retail employees then it will be expanded. The instructors must spend a minimum of 40 hours in their regular duty assignment every four months.

Instructors qualifying for a uniform allowance must be in full uniform at all times while training.

Experience Requirements: Successful instructors must have one year of continuous retail experience and hold a retail duty assignment at the time of consideration:

- Lead Sales and Services Associate, (P7-07) (2320-0009**)**
- Sales, Services/Distribution Associate, (P7-06) (2320-0003)
- Sales and Services Associate, (P7-06) (2320-0001**)**
- Window Clerk, (P7-06) (2320-01XX)
- Distribution and Window Clerk, (P7-06) (2340-00XX)
- Distribution, Window, and Mark-Up Clerk, (P7-06) (2340-80XX)
- Delivery/Sales Services and Distribution Associate, (P7-06) (2320-0007)

Successful ad-hoc Classroom Instructors and Retail Coaches are paid at the (PS-7) rate

Qualifications: Successful completion of:

- Facilitative Instructor Workshop (21201-61 or 10020351)
- RET: SSA: Retail Coaching Guidelines (10021227)
- Job Instructor Training (21505-00)